INCH-POUND

MIL-PRF-24385F(SH)
w/AMENDMENT 5
24 August 2026
SUPERSEDING
MIL-PRF-24385F(SH)
w/AMENDMENT 4
7 April 2020

PERFORMANCE SPECIFICATION

FIRE EXTINGUISHING AGENT, AQUEOUS FILM-FORMING FOAM (AFFF) LIQUID CONCENTRATE, FOR FRESH AND SEA WATER

This specification is approved for use by the Naval Sea Systems Command and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for aqueous film-forming foam (AFFF) liquid concentrate fire extinguishing agents consisting of surfactants and other compounds, as required, to conform to this specification. At the time of use, concentrates are to be diluted with fresh or sea water to form a fire-extinguishing solution. Certain proportioning equipment may produce AFFF solutions of extreme concentrations; requirements for such concentrations are specified herein.

1.2 Classification. Concentrates are of the following types, as specified (see 6.2):

Type 3 - To be used as three parts concentrate to ninety-seven parts water by volume solution.
Type 6 - To be used as six parts concentrate to ninety-four parts water by volume solution.

2. APPLICABLE PUBLICATIONS

2.1 General. The publications listed in this section are specified in sections 3 and 4 of this specification. This section does not include publications cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, users of this document are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements of publications cited in sections 3 and 4 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

2.2 Government publications.

2.2.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these publications are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

FEDERAL SPECIFICATIONS

DELETED

O-D-1407 - Dry Chemical, Fire Extinguishing, Potassium Bicarbonate

Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be addressed to: Commander, Naval Sea Systems Command, ATTN: SEA 05T, 1333 Isaac Hull Avenue, SE, Stop 5160, Washington Navy Yard DC 20376-5160 or emailed to CommandStandards@navy.mil, with the subject line "Document Comment". Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using ASSIST at https://assist.dla.mil.

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DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE SPECIFICATIONS

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DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE STANDARDS

MIL-STD-129 - Military Marking for Shipment and Storage

MIL-STD-130 - Identification Marking of U.S. Military Property

MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads

(Copies of these publications are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil.)

2.2.2 Other Government publications. The following other Government publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these publications are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

CODE OF FEDERAL REGULATIONS (CFR)

49 CFR 178.2 - Applicability and Responsibility

(Copies of this publication are available online at www.ecfr.gov.)

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE

DoD AFFF01 - Determination of Perfluorooctanoic acid and Perfluorooctanesulfonic acid in Aqueous Film Forming Foam (AFFF) for Demonstration of Compliance to MIL-PRF-24385

DoD/DoE QSM - Department of Defense (DoD) Department of Energy (DOE) Consolidated Quality Systems Manual (QSM) for Environmental Laboratories

(Copies of these publications are available online at https://www.denix.osd.mil/edqw/quality-systems-manuals/.)

U.S. ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA) PUBLICATIONS

EPA Method 1633 - Analysis of Per- and Polyfluoroalkyl Substances (PFAS) in Aqueous, Solid, Biosolids, and Tissue Samples by LC-MS/MS

(Copies of this publication are available online at https://www.epa.gov/.)

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2.3 Non-Government publications. The following publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these publications are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

ASTM INTERNATIONAL

ASTM A342/A342M - Standard Test Methods for Permeability of Weakly Magnetic Materials

ASTM D445 - Standard Test Method for Kinematic Viscosity of Transparent and Opaque Liquids (and Calculation of Dynamic Viscosity)

ASTM D1141 - Standard Practice for the Preparation of Substitute Ocean Water

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ASTM D1331	-	Standard Test Methods for Surface and Interfacial Tension of Solutions of Paints, Solvents, Solutions of Surface-Active Agents, and Related Materials
ASTM D1796	-	Standard Test Method for Water and Sediment in Fuel Oils by the Centrifuge Method (Laboratory Procedure)
ASTM D3953	-	Standard Specification for Strapping, Flat Steel and Seals
ASTM D4814	-	Standard Specification for Automotive Spark-Ignition Engine Fuel
ASTM D5998	-	Standard Specification for Molded Polyethylene Shipping and Storage Drums
ASTM D6199	-	Standard Practice for Quality of Wood Members of Containers and Pallets
ASTM E11	-	Standard Specification for Woven Wire Test Sieve Cloth and Test Sieves
ASTM E527	-	Standard Practice for Numbering Metals and Alloys in the Unified Numbering System (UNS)
ASTM E729	-	Standard Guide for Conducting Acute Toxicity Tests on Test Materials with Fishes, Macroinvertebrates, and Amphibians

(Copies of these publications are available online at https://www.astm.org.)

AMERICAN PUBLIC HEALTH ASSOCIATION

Standard Methods for the Examination of Water and Wastewater

(Copies of this publication are available online at https://www.standardmethods.org.)

NATIONAL FIRE PROTECTION ASSOCIATION (NFPA)

NFPA 460 - Standard for Aircraft Rescue and Firefighting Services at Airports

(Copies of this publication are available online at https://www.nfpa.org.)

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION (NMFTA)

National Motor Freight Classification

(Copies of this publication are available online at https://nmfta.org/.)

SAE INTERNATIONAL

SAE-AMS-STD-595 - Colors Used in Government Procurement

(Copies of this publication are available online at https://www.sae.org.)

UNDERWRITERS LABORATORIES, INC. (UL)

UL 162 - Standard for Safety Foam Equipment and Liquid Concentrates

(Copies of this publication are available online at https://www.ul.com.)

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UNITED NATIONS

ST/SG/AC.10/1 (Vol.II) - Recommendations on the Transport of Dangerous Goods

(Copies of this publication are available online at https://unece.org/publications/oes/welcome.)

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2.4 Order of precedence. Unless otherwise noted herein or in the contract, in the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Qualification. Liquid concentrate fire extinguishing agents furnished under this specification shall be products that are authorized by the qualifying activity for listing on the applicable qualified products list (QPL) before contract award (see 4.3 and 6.4).

3.2 Materials. Concentrates shall consist of surfactants plus other compounds as required to conform to the requirements specified hereinafter. The material shall have no adverse effect on the health of personnel when used for its intended purpose.

3.3 Concentrate characteristics. Concentrates shall conform to the chemical and physical requirements shown in table I.

3.3.1 Film formation and sealability. The foam produced film shall spread over the fuel surface and seal off vapor production to prevent sustained ignition (see 4.7.6).

3.3.2 Stability. The concentrate (Type 3 or Type 6) and a 3 percent premix solution of Type 3 or a 6 percent premix solution of Type 6 as applicable shall conform to the following requirements after 10 days storage at 65 Celsius (°C) ±2.0 °C (see 4.7.10):

a. Spreading coefficient: (See table I)
b. Foamability: (See table I)
c. Film formation and sealability: As specified in 3.3.1
d. Fire performance, 28 square feet (ft²) fire, 1.5 and 3 percent of Type 3 and 3 and 6 percent of Type 6 fresh and sea water solutions: As specified in 3.4
e. Stratification: No visible evidence following test (see 4.7.14)
f. Precipitation: 0.05 percent by volume (see 4.7.15).

3.3.3 Compatibility. The concentrates of one manufacturer shall be compatible in all proportions with concentrate furnished by other manufacturers listed on the qualified products list. The material shall also be compatible with materials in inventory which were acquired under previous issues of this specification and known to be still in use in significant quantities. Information regarding these materials may be obtained from NAVSEA. The concentrate shall conform to the following requirements after 10 days storage at 65 °C ±2.0 °C (see 4.7.11):

a. Foamability: (See table I)
b. Film formation and sealability: As specified in 3.3.1
c. Fire performance 28 ft², 3 percent of Type 3 and 6 percent of Type 6 fresh and sea water solution: As specified in 3.4
d. Stratification: No visible evidence following test (see 4.7.14)
e. Precipitation: 0.05 percent by volume (see 4.7.15).

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TABLE I. Chemical and physical requirements for concentrates or solutions.

Requirement	Values		Applicable publication	Test paragraph
	Type 3	Type 6		
Refractive index, minimum	1.3630	1.3580	-	4.7.1
Viscosity, centistokes:			ASTM D445	4.7.2
Maximum at 5 °C	20	10		
Minimum at 25 °C	2	2		
Hydrogen ion concentration (pH)	7.0 to 8.5	7.0 to 8.5	-	4.7.5
Spreading coefficient, minimum	3	3	-	4.7.4
Foamability:				
Foam expansion, minimum	5.0	5.0	NFPA 460	4.7.5
Foam 25% drainage time, minutes, minimum	2.5	2.5	NFPA 460	4.7.5
Corrosion rate:				
General				
Cold rolled, low carbon steel (UNS G10100), milli in/yr, maximum	1.5	1.5	ASTM E527	4.7.7
Copper-nickel (90-10) (UNS C70600), milli in/yr, maximum	1.0	1.0	ASTM E527	4.7.7
Nickel-copper (70-30) (UNS N04400), milli in/yr, maximum	1.0	1.0	ASTM E527	4.7.7
Bronze (UNS C90500), milligrams, maximum	100	100	ASTM E527	4.7.7
Localized, corrosion-resistant (CRES) steel, (UNS S30400)	No pits	No pits	-	4.7.7
Perfluorooctanoic acid (PFOA) content, ppb, maximum	800	800	EPA 1633	4.7.8
Perfluorooctane Sulfonate (PFOS) content, ppb, maximum	800	800	EPA 1633	4.7.8
Dry chemical compatibility, burn-back, resistance time, seconds, minimum	360	360	-	4.7.9
Environmental impact:				
Toxicity, LC_{50}, mg/L, minimum	500	1000	-	4.7.12.1
COD, mg/L, maximum	1000K	500K	-	4.7.12.2
$\frac{BOD}{COD}20$, minimum	0.65	0.65	-	4.7.12.3

NOTE:
1/ DELETED.

3.3.4 Total fluorine content. DELETED.

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3.4 Fire performance. The foam shall conform to the fire performance requirements shown in table II.

TABLE II. Fire performance.

	AFFF solutions, percent		
	1.5% of Type 3 3.0% of Type 6	**3% of Type 3 6% of Type 6**	**15% of Type 3 30% of Type 6**
	(Fresh and sea)	**(Fresh and sea)**	**(Sea)**
28-ft² fire (see 4.7.13.1):			
Foam application time to extinguish, seconds, maximum	45	30	55
Burnback time of resulting foam cover, seconds, minimum	300	360	200
50-ft² fire (see 4.7.13.2):			
Foam application time to extinguish, seconds, maximum		50 (Sea only)	
Burnback time of resulting foam cover, seconds, minimum		360	
40-second summation, minimum		320	

3.5 Marking.

3.5.1 Identification marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-130. In addition, the marking on the containers (see 5.3) shall be in white characters against a green background for Type 3, a blue background for Type 6.

3.5.2 Two identical markings conforming to figures 1 and 2 shall be applied to containers so that the markings are located diametrically opposite. The markings shall be applied on the containers in such a manner that water immersion contact with the contents of the containers, or normal handling will not impair the legibility of the marking. Paper labels shall not be used.

4. VERIFICATION

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to ensure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. Qualification inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).
   (1) Examination of filled containers
   (2) Quality conformance inspection.

4.3 Qualification inspection. Qualification inspection shall be conducted at a laboratory satisfactory to the Naval Sea Systems Command. Qualification inspection shall consist of the inspections and tests shown in table III.

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TABLE III. Qualification and quality conformance inspections.

Examination or test	Reference paragraph		Qualification	Quality conformance
	Requirement	Test		
Refractive index	3.3	4.7.1	X	X
Viscosity	3.3	4.7.2	X	X
pH value	3.3	4.7.3	X	X
Spreading coefficient	3.3	4.7.4	X	X
Foamability	3.3	4.7.5	X	X 3/
Film formation and sealability	3.3.1	4.7.6	X	X
General corrosion	3.3	4.7.7	X	
Localized corrosion	3.3	4.7.7	X	
PFOA content	3.3	4.7.8	X	
PFOS content	3.3	4.7.8	X	
DELETED				
Dry chemical compatibility	3.3	4.7.9	X	
Stability	3.3.2	4.7.10	X	
Compatibility	3.3.3	4.7.11	X	
Environmental impact	3.3	4.7.12	X	
28-ft² fire test	3.4	4.7.13	X	
50-ft² fire test	3.4	4.7.13	X	X 2/ 3/
Examination of filled containers		4.6		X
Torque to remove cap 1/	5.1.1.1.1f	4.7.17.2	X	X

NOTES:

1/ Torque test to be performed a minimum of 48 hours after initial closure.

2/ Alternatively, the 28-ft² lean (1.5%) sea water fire test from 3.4 can be utilized to satisfy conformance testing requirements.

3/ The fire and foamability tests are only required to be performed every 20 manufacturing lots.

4.3.1 Samples for qualification inspection. One hundred gallons of Type 3 and 200 gallons of Type 6 are required for the qualification inspection.

4.4 Sampling for quality conformance inspection.

4.4.1 Inspection lot. A lot shall consist of all foam manufactured as one unchanged process batch and transferred from one mixing tank to the shipping container.

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4.4.2 Sampling for examination of filled containers. As a minimum, the contractor shall randomly select a sample quantity from each lot of filled containers in accordance with table IV and examine them in accordance with 4.6, 5.1.1.1, and 5.1.1.2. The sample size depends on lot size. If one or more defects are found in any sample, the entire lot shall be rejected. The contractor has the option of screening 100 percent of the rejected lot for the defective characteristics, or providing a new lot, which shall be examined in accordance with the sampling plan contained herein. The contractor shall maintain for a period of three years after contract completion, records of inspections, tests, and any resulting rejections. For fire and foamability testing, the contractor has the option to arrange for testing to be conducted at a laboratory satisfactory to NAVSEA.

TABLE IV. Sample size for examination of filled containers.

Lot size	Sample size
2-5	All
6-50	5
51-90	7
91-150	11
151-280	13
281-500	16
501-1,200	19
1,201-3,200	23

4.4.3 Sampling for quality conformance inspection. Three filled 5-gallon containers shall be selected at random from each lot and used for the tests specified in 4.6, or three 5-gallon containers of the product shall be withdrawn from an agitated mixing tank prior to packaging. If fire and foamability testing is performed at a third-party laboratory, two of these 5-gallon containers shall be reserved for that purpose. The results of the tests required by 4.5 shall be submitted to NAVSEA or the designated laboratory.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. The samples selected in accordance with 4.4.3 shall be subjected to the quality conformance inspection of table III. If the sample tested is found to be not in conformance with any of the quality conformance tests, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.6 Examination of filled containers. Each sample filled container shall be examined for defects of construction of the container and the closure, for evidence of leakage, and for unsatisfactory markings. Each filled container shall also be weighed to determine the amount of contents.

4.7 Test procedure.[1] Test procedures shall be as follows:

4.7.1 Refractive index. The refractive index shall be determined at 25 °C ±0.1 °C, using sodium vapor source lamp illumination.

4.7.2 Viscosity. The viscosity shall be determined at temperatures of 5 °C ±0.1 °C and 25 °C ±0.1 °C in accordance with ASTM D445, using capillary viscosimeters in the appropriate size.

4.7.3 pH value. The pH value shall be determined potentiometrically, using a pH meter with a glass electrode and a reference electrode, at 25 °C ±1.0 °C.

[1] Where sea water is required for tests, synthetic sea water in accordance with ASTM D1141 shall be used. A sea salt mixture conforming to this standard may be purchased from Lake Products Company, Inc., P.O. Box 2248, St. Louis, Missouri 63043.

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4.7.4 Spreading coefficient. The spreading coefficient shall be determined with reference to cyclohexane in accordance with the following relationship:

Where: $S_{a/b} = \gamma_b - \gamma_a - \gamma_i$

$S_{a/b}$ = Spreading coefficient

γ_b = Surface tension of cyclohexane as determined in 4.7.4.1

γ_a = Surface tension of AFFF solution as determined in 4.7.4.1

γ_i = Interfacial tension between liquids as determined in 4.7.4.2

4.7.4.1 Surface tension. The surface tension of 3±0.05 percent of Type 3 or 6±0.1 percent of Type 6 by volume in distilled water, as appropriate, and of reagent grade cyclohexane shall be determined with a DuNoy tensiometer, or equal, at 23 °C ±2.0 °C in accordance with ASTM D1331.

4.7.4.2 Interfacial tension. The interfacial tension between 3±0.05 percent of Type 3 or 6±0.1 percent of Type 6 by volume in distilled water, as appropriate, and reagent grade cyclohexane shall be determined with a DuNoy tensiometer, or equal, at 23 °C ±2.0 °C until the readings come to equilibrium and in accordance with ASTM D1331.

4.7.5 Foamability. The foam shall be generated by means of a special 2-gallons-per-minute (gal/min) test nozzle. The basic nozzle, as made by National Foam System, Inc., Lionville, Pennsylvania, or equal, shall be modified by shortening the length of the foam barrel from 2½ to 1¼ inches, and by adding a "wing-tip" spreader on the outlet. The spreader shall have a ⅛-inch wide, circular orifice, 1⅞ inches long. (It may be made by slightly compressing a Bernz-o-matic TX-1527, or equal, flame spreader.) A print of the nozzle construction is available from the Naval Research Laboratory, Code 6180, Washington, DC 20375. During foam sample collection, the nozzle inlet pressure shall be maintained at a gauge pressure of 100 pounds per square inch (lb/in²), and the solution temperature at 23 °C ±5.0 °C. The nozzle shall be held at hip height and directed onto the backboard from a distance of 4 to 6 feet. The method and procedure shall be in accordance with NFPA 460. Foamability shall be run on 6 percent fresh and sea water solutions of the Type 6 concentrate and 3 percent fresh and sea water solutions of the Type 3 concentrate.

4.7.6 Film formation and sealability.

4.7.6.1 Test equipment. A CRES graduated measure of 1,000-milliliter (mL) capacity (4½ inches in diameter, 5 inches deep; Cole-Parmer Co., Chicago, Illinois, or equal) shall be fitted with two retaining clips at the top edge. The clips serve to restrain a cone 5 inches in height and 4¾ inches in diameter, made of 80-mesh perforated CRES, in an inverted position inside the measure. The 2-gal/min nozzle specified in 4.7.5 shall be used for foam production.

4.7.6.2 Test procedure. After placing 400 mL of water and 200 mL of 98-percent cyclohexane in the measure, 200 mL of freshly-made foam shall be poured onto the fuel. The inverted cone shall be pushed down into the measure, thereby pushing most of the foam aside but allowing the film-producing liquid to creep in through the mesh openings. A foam-free surface shall be created by manually scooping out most of the residual foam from the center of the cone. After a 1-minute waiting period, a pilot flame shall be passed over the fuel surface at a height of about ½ inch. A small flash is permitted, but no sustained ignition shall result, if an effective vapor seal is present. A 1-inch long pilot flame shall be provided with a hand-held propane cylinder fitted with a capillary tubing outlet.

4.7.7 Corrosion. The liquid for immersion of the metal specimens for general corrosion and localized corrosion tests shall consist of the concentrate diluted by 10 percent by volume with sea water.

4.7.7.1 General corrosion.

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4.7.7.1.1 Test specimens. The test specimens shall consist of the following metals, in accordance with UNS designations (see ASTM E527): G10100 steel, C70600 copper-nickel alloy, N04400 nickel-copper, and C90500 bronze. All specimens, except the bronze, shall be milled to finished dimensions of approximately 1/16 inch thick, 1/2 inch wide, and 3 inches long. The bronze shall have sand cast faces and be approximately 3/16 inch thick, 1/2 inch wide, and 3 inches long. All specimens shall be degreased in acetone, rinsed with distilled water, and air dried before exposure. (Prepared metal specimens may be obtained from the Metaspec Company, 355 Spencer Ln, Suite 1-112, San Antonio, TX 78201; https://www.metaspec.com/).

4.7.7.1.2 Test procedures. Five weighted specimens of each metal shall be fully immersed in the test medium in a separate 600-mL beaker and held at room temperature for a period of 60 days. A watch-glass cover shall be used to retard evaporation. At the end of the exposure period, the weight-loss shall be determined and the corrosion rate calculated as required.

4.7.7.2 Localized corrosion.

4.7.7.2.1 Test specimens. The test specimens shall consist of UNS S30400 CRES milled to finished dimensions of approximately 1/16 inch thick, 1/2 inch wide, and 3 inches long. After degreasing with acetone, rinsing with distilled water, and air drying before exposure, the specimens shall be pretreated by immersion in a 1:9 concentrated nitric acid-water solution for the period of 5 minutes.

4.7.7.2.2 Procedure. Ten specimens shall be girdled lengthwise with a clean 1/16 to 1/8-inch wide band of a good grade of gum rubber of a size such that the band is taut during the test. Because of the poor quality of most commercial rubber bands, it is recommended that the bands for this test be cut from 1¾ inch flat width pure gum amber tubing (Preiser Scientific Rubber tubing, Pure Gum, Gooch type, 1/32-inch thin wall, pure gum amber tubing, very elastic, especially made for Gooch crucibles, or equal). This tubing is most easily cut into uniform strips with a blade-type papercutter, but can also be cut with sharp shears. The specimens girdled with the rubber bands shall be placed in a 600-mL beaker so that no contact is made between individual specimens. A ¼-inch layer of glass beads shall be introduced into the beaker to aid in stabilizing specimen position. Enough liquid shall be added to completely immerse the specimens, and a watch-glass shall be placed over the beaker to retard evaporation (but allow air access) and act as a dust cover, and the assemblies allowed to stand at room temperature for 60 days.

4.7.7.2.3 Results. The specimens shall be monitored daily over the 60-day period to ascertain the presence or absence of pitting. These daily examinations shall be made without disturbing the test (other than removing the cover). Corrosion is customarily signaled by the appearance of a dark spot which, if removed after sufficient exposure, discloses a corrosion pit. If the suspected area cannot be positively identified by the naked eye, it can be at a magnification of 10X. At the end of the test, each specimen shall be inspected carefully with particular attention being given to the edges of the specimens and those areas of the specimens under or adjacent to the rubber bands. 10X magnification shall be used, if necessary.

4.7.8 PFOA and PFOS content. The collection of samples for tests for PFOA and PFOS content shall be accomplished in accordance with DoD AFFF01. The tests for PFOA and PFOS content shall be conducted by a DoD Environmental Laboratory Accreditation Program (ELAP) laboratory that is accredited to perform the analysis of AFFF samples for the determination of PFOA and PFOS content using EPA Method 1633. The evaluation of PFOA and PFOS content shall be performed in accordance with the requirement for the evaluation of AFFF samples contained in the PFAS Analysis by LC/MS/MS table of the DoD/DOE QSM. The subsamples shall be prepared in accordance with DoD/DOE QSM requirements.

4.7.8.1 PFOA content. PFOA content shall be determined in accordance with 4.7.8. Results shall be expressed in parts per billion (ppb).

4.7.8.2 PFOS content. PFOS content shall be determined in accordance with 4.7.8. Results shall be expressed in ppb.

4.7.9 Dry chemical compatibility. The foam's compatibility with potassium bicarbonate dry chemical extinguishing agent shall be determined by measuring the burnback time in the presence of dry chemical.

4.7.9.1 Test materials. The fuel shall be unleaded gasoline conforming to ASTM D4814. The dry chemical agent shall conform to O-D-1407. The sieve shall be an 8-inch diameter, 40-mesh sieve conforming to ASTM E11.

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4.7.9.2 Test procedure. A 28-square-foot fire test shall be conducted in accordance with 4.7.13.1 using Type 3 or 6 AFFF sea water solution, as required. Before placing the burning pan, 1 pound of dry chemical agent shall be evenly distributed over the foam blanket with the aid of a sieve on a long handle. This shall be accomplished within a 30-second period so that the total time from end of foam application to placement of the burning pan will not be longer than 90 seconds. The burnback time shall be determined as in 4.7.13.1.4.

4.7.10 Stability.

4.7.10.1 Sample preparation. Samples of concentrate, and Type 3 and Type 6 AFFF fresh water and sea water solution, as appropriate, shall be prepared in sufficient quantity to perform the required tests. One liter (L) of each shall be placed in lightly stoppered glass cylinders. All samples shall then be stored at 65 °C ±2.0 °C for a period of 10 days. The samples shall then be subjected to the following tests:

a.	Spreading coefficient	4.7.4
b.	Foamability	4.7.5
c.	Film formation and sealability	4.7.6
d.	Fire performance (28 ft²)	4.7.13.1
e.	Stratification	4.7.14
f.	Precipitation	4.7.15

NOTE: In the preparation of the samples to be used for the precipitation test, the synthetic sea water shall be filtered prior to use.

4.7.11 Compatibility.

4.7.11.1 Sample preparation. The Government will provide samples of appropriate qualified product(s) to manufacturers officially authorized to submit candidate material for qualification (see 3.3.3). Mixtures of the Type 3 and Type 6 concentrates to be tested shall be prepared in sufficient quantities to perform the required tests. (For qualification testing, the testing activity will determine the number of product mixtures to be evaluated and the ratio of product comprising these mixtures.) Additionally, 3 percent of Type 3 or 6 percent of Type 6 AFFF fresh water and sea water solutions shall be prepared from each concentrate mixture. One L of each shall be placed in lightly stoppered glass cylinders. The samples shall be stored at 65 °C ±2.0 °C for a period of 10 days. The samples shall then be subjected to the following tests:

a.	Foamability	4.7.5
b.	Film formation and sealability	4.7.6
c.	Fire performance (28 ft²)	4.7.13.1
d.	Stratification	4.7.14
e.	Precipitation	4.7.15

4.7.12 Environmental impact.

4.7.12.1 Toxicity. Toxicity test shall be performed on the Killiefish (Fundulus herteroclitus) in accordance with ASTM E729, using dynamic procedures. The minimum acceptable dissolved oxygen content of water used in this procedure shall be 5 p/m.

4.7.12.2 Chemical oxygen demand (COD). COD shall be determined in accordance with procedures in Standard Method for the Examination of Water and Wastewater (latest applicable edition).

4.7.12.3 Biodegradability. Biodegradability shall be determined by dividing the value expressed in mg/L for the 20-day biological oxygen demand (BOD20) determined from 5-day BOD test in accordance with the procedure specified in Standard Methods for the Examination of Water and Wastewater (latest applicable edition) by the value expressed in mg/L for COD determined as specified in 4.7.12.2.

4.7.13 Fire test. No fire test shall be conducted when the wind speed is above 10 miles per hour (mi/hr). These tests are normally conducted indoors to avoid adverse weather conditions.

4.7.13.1 Twenty-eight-square-foot fire test.

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4.7.13.1.1 Test equipment. The fire test shall be conducted in a level, circular pan 6 feet in diameter, fabricated from ¼-inch thick steel with a 4-inch high side. A shallow water layer shall be used to protect the pan bottom and to ensure complete coverage of the area with fuel. The nozzle used for foam application shall be the 2 gal/min device specified in 4.7.5.

4.7.13.1.2 Test materials. Foam shall be generated at 23 °C ±5.0 °C from AFFF solutions made with fresh or sea water, as required, at concentration values shown in table V. The fuel shall be 10 gallons of unleaded gasoline conforming to ASTM D4814.

TABLE V. AFFF test concentration values.

Solutions	Type 3	Type 6
Lean 1/	1.5±0.03	3±0.1
Normal strength	3±0.05	6±0.1
Rich 2/	15±0.2	30±0.2
1/ One test with fresh water and one with sea water. 2/ One test with sea water.		

4.7.13.1.3 Test procedure. The fuel shall be dumped within a 30-second period. The fuel shall be ignited within 30 seconds of fueling and allowed to burn freely for 10 seconds. After the preburn period, the fire shall be attacked and extinguished as expeditiously as possible and the fire extinguishing time shall be recorded at the exact cessation of all flame, but foam application shall continue for a total of 90 seconds.

4.7.13.1.4 Burnback procedure. Within 60 seconds of the completion of foam application, a burning pan (1-foot diameter with 2-inch side) containing one gallon of unleaded gasoline shall be placed in the center of the 28-square-foot pan and a timer started. When it appears that the fire has spread outside the pan so that the burning will continue after pan removal, the pan shall be removed. The burnback time is that at which it is estimated that 7 square feet (25 percent) of the total area is involved in flames.

NOTE: Intermittent “flash-overs” may occur. They are characterized by creeping faint blue or invisible flames over the foam surface which usually self-extinguish. They are not considered a part of the burnback area unless sustained burning occurs. All isolated, sustained burning areas shall be included in arriving at the 7-square-foot total area.

4.7.13.2 Fifty-square-foot fire test.

4.7.13.2.1 Test site. The fire test shall be conducted on a level, circular area 8 feet in diameter. The base and surrounding wall shall be suitable for containment of the fuel on a substrate of water. The water depth shall be the minimum required to ensure complete coverage area with the fuel.

4.7.13.2.2 Test equipment. The nozzle used for foam application shall be the 2 gal/min device specified in 4.7.5, operated at a gauge pressure of 100 lb/in^2.

4.7.13.2.3 Test materials. The foam shall be generated at 23 °C ±5.0 °C from 3±0.05 percent of Type 3 or 6±0.1 percent of Type 6 AFFF solutions made with sea water. The fuel shall be 15 gallons of unleaded gasoline conforming to ASTM D4814.

4.7.13.2.4 Test procedure. The fuel shall be dumped into the area in less than 60 seconds and ignited in less than 30 seconds after fuel dumping is completed. After allowing a preburn period of 10 seconds, the fire shall be attacked and extinguished in an expeditious manner. At 10-second intervals after the start of foam application, observers shall estimate the percentage of fire area extinguished. The percentages at 10, 20, 30, and 40 seconds shall be totaled to give the “40-second summation” value. The exact extinguishing time shall also be recorded at the cessation of all flame, but foam application shall continue for a total of 90 seconds.

4.7.13.2.5 Burnback procedure. Within 60 seconds of the completion of foam application, a burnback test shall be conducted as specified in 4.7.13.1.4, except that the burnback area shall be 12.5 square feet (25 percent).

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4.7.14 Stratification. The presence of stratification shall be determined by visual examination of the samples contained in the glass cylinders.

4.7.15 Precipitation. The amount of precipitation shall be determined in accordance with the procedures of ASTM D1796.

4.7.16 Fluorine content. DELETED.

4.7.16.1 Qualification. DELETED.

4.7.16.2 Quality conformance inspection. DELETED.

4.7.17 Packaging inspection. Sample packages and packs and the inspection of preservation, packaging, packing, and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with the requirements of 4.6, section 5, and the documents specified therein. The magnetic permeability test (for metal handles of 5-gallon containers) of 4.7.16.1 and the torque test (for the pour cap of 5-gallon containers) of 4.7.17.2 shall be included.

4.7.17.1 Magnetic permeability (metal handles of 5-gallon containers). The metal handles of the 5-gallon containers shall be checked to determine conformance with the magnetic requirements of 5.1.1.1.1d using a permeability indicator, low-mu (GO-NO-GO) in accordance with ASTM A342/A342M.

4.7.17.2 Torque test (pour cap of 5-gallon container). The pour cap of the 5-gallon container shall be subjected to a torque test to determine conformance with 5.1.1.1.1f.

5. PACKAGING

(The packaging requirements specified herein apply only for direct Government acquisitions. For the extent of applicability of the packaging requirements of referenced documents listed in section 2, see 6.5.)

5.1 Preservation-packaging. Preservation-packaging for Level A shall be as specified hereinafter.

5.1.1 The AFFF liquid concentrate shall be furnished in a 5-gallon or in a 55-gallon plastic container as specified (see 6.2d).

5.1.1.1 Five-gallon plastic container. The container shall be molded polyethylene as specified herein. The container shall be as follows:

a.	Capacity	5 gallons (min.)
b.	Height, body (overall)	15 inches (max.)
c.	Diameter, body (overall)	11¾ inches (max.)
d.	Pour opening (inside dia.)	1½ inches (min.)

5.1.1.1.1 The container shall be UL-listed as “Component – Containers for Foam Liquid Concentrates” in accordance with UL 162 or tested and marked in accordance with the requirements for the construction and testing of packagings of UN ST/SG/AC.10/1 (Vol.II), and as follows:

a. Shall be stackable and self-supporting.

b. Shall be provided with a threaded-type plastic cap fitted with a gasket for the pour opening.

c. May be provided with a vent opening having an easily punctured membrane. When furnished, vent opening shall be provided with a threaded type plastic cap.

d. Shall be provided with an integrally molded or recessible plastic or metal handle. Metal handles shall not exceed a magnetic permeability of 2.0.

e. Shall have colors conforming to 5.1.1.3, Type 3 green, Type 6 blue.

f. The torque required to remove the pour opening cap shall not exceed 50 inch-pounds.

g. For shipping, the caps shall be tightened to the container manufacturer’s specification in accordance with 49 CFR 178.2(c)(1)(i)(B).

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5.1.1.2 Fifty-five gallon plastic container. The 55-gallon containers shall be molded polyethylene in accordance with ASTM D5998.

5.1.1.3 Exterior color and coating. The green color (see 3.5) shall be an approximate match to color number 14187 of SAE-AMS-STD-595. The blue color (see 3.5) shall be an approximate match to color number 15123 of SAE-AMS-STD-595.

5.2 Packing. For Level A no further packing is required.

5.2.1 Method of shipment shall comply with National Motor Freight Classification system or other carrier rules as applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.2.2 Palletization.

a. Thirty-six 5-gallon plastic containers shall be palletized in accordance with the requirements of MIL-STD-147, Load Type XVII. Containers shall be properly and firmly nested and arranged to ensure a snug, non-shifting load. Pallet dimensions may be adjusted to ensure a snug, non-shifting load, but shall not exceed 43 by 52 inches.

b. Inverted caps. The inverted cap shall be the open sheathing type, wood group optional.

c. Top wood cap. The top wood cap shall be the closed sheathing (plywood) wood cap, wood group optional for slats. In addition, each corner of the plywood cap shall be secured to the end and side slats with strapping. Strapping shall be ¾ inch by 0.035 inch and shall extend a minimum of 3 inches into the plywood top and slats. Nails used to secure the strapping shall be clinched.

d. Strapping. All primary, secondary, auxiliary, and horizontal strapping shall not be less than 1¼ inches by 0.035 inch. Strapping shall conform to ASTM D3953, Type I, Finish B. Cross ties shall be applied in accordance with MIL-STD-147.

e. Side frames. Minimum size of side frame members shall be a nominal 1 by 6 inches conforming to Group I, II, III,or IV of ASTM D6199. Nails used to secure flat surfaces of side frames shall be clinched not less than ¼ inch.

5.3 Marking. In addition to the marking specified in 3.5 and any special marking required (see 6.2), containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The concentrate is intended for use in mechanical foam generating equipment such as fire-fighting trucks or foam sprinkler systems for extinguishing fires in flammable liquids such as gasoline or fuel oils. Type 6 is intended for use in proportioners designed to dispense only the 6-percent solution (usually shipboard fire protection systems). Type 3 may be used in any equipment capable of proportioning at variable rates or at fixed 3-percent solution. Current stock of AFFF may be used until depleted; future requisitions for AFFF should refer to the current version of this specification.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. The specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.2.1 and 2.3).
c. Type of concentrate required (see 1.2).
d. Size of container required (see 5.1.1).
e. Special marking, if required (see 5.3).

6.3 Consideration of data requirements. DELETED.

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6.4 Qualification. With respect to products requiring qualification, awards will be made only for products which are, at the time of award of contract, qualified for inclusion in Qualified Products List QPL No. 24385 whether or not such products have actually been so listed by that date. The attention of the contractors is called to these requirements, and manufacturers are urged to arrange to have the products that they propose to offer to the Federal Government tested for qualification in order that they may be eligible to be awarded contracts or orders for the products covered by this specification. Information pertaining to qualification of products may be obtained from Commander, Naval Sea Systems Command, ATTN: SEA 05T, 1333 Isaac Hull Avenue, SE, Stop 5160, Washington Navy Yard DC 20376-5160 or emailed to CommandStandards@navy.mil. An online listing of products qualified to this specification may be found in the Qualified Products Database (QPD) at https://assist.dla.mil.

6.4.1 Provisions governing qualification. Copies of SD-6 “Provisions Governing Qualification” are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil or https://assist.dla.mil.

6.5 Sub-contracted material and parts. The packaging requirements of referenced documents listed in section 2 do not apply when material is acquired by the contractor for incorporation into the concentrate and lose separate identity when the concentrate is shipped.

6.6 PFOA and PFOS content. The DoD’s goal is to acquire and use a non-fluorinated AFFF formulation or equivalent firefighting agent to meet the performance requirements for DoD critical firefighting needs. The DoD is funding research to this end, but a viable solution may not be found for several years. In the short term, the DoD intends to acquire and use AFFF with the lowest demonstrable concentrations of two particular per- and PFAS; specifically PFOS and PFOA. The DoD intends to be open and transparent with Congress, the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA), state regulators, and the public at large regarding DoD efforts to address these matters. AFFF manufacturers and vendors are encouraged to determine the levels of PFOS, PFOA, and other PFAS in their products and work to drive these levels toward zero while still meeting all other military specification requirements.

6.7 Subject term (key word) listing.

Firefighting

Fire-fighting

6.8 Amendment notations. The margins of this specification are marked with vertical lines to indicate modifications generated by this amendment. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations.

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U.S.

AQUEOUS FILM FORMING FOAM (AFFF) LIQUID CONCENTRATE

In accordance with

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE SPECIFICATION MIL-PRF-24385

TYPE 3 (3%)

NSN _____

This fire extinguishing concentrate is for use by dilution with water in fixed or mobile systems. It may be used alone or in combination with "twinned" dry chemical equipment. The concentrate may be diluted for use in flow proportioning equipment with sea water or fresh water at volume proportions of three gallons concentrate to 97 gallons water. It may also be diluted for ready-use storage at a three percent premixed foam solution with fresh water. For ready use do not store below 35 °F and avoid prolonged storage above 120 °F. Only mix with other Type 3 liquid concentrate in accordance with MIL-PRF-24385 and water.

MANUFACTURER'S NAME

CORPORATE ADDRESS

MANUFACTURING ADDRESS

PRODUCT NAME

BATCH NO.

DATE OF MANUFACTURE

FIGURE 1. Type 3 container markings.

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U.S.

AQUEOUS FILM FORMING FOAM (AFFF) LIQUID CONCENTRATE

In accordance with

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE SPECIFICATION MIL-PRF-24385

TYPE 6 (6%)

NSN _____

This fire extinguishing concentrate is for use by dilution with water in fixed or mobile systems. It may be used alone or in combination with "twinned" dry chemical equipment. The concentrate may be diluted for use in flow proportioning equipment with sea water or fresh water at volume proportions of six gallons concentrate to 94 gallons water. It may also be diluted for ready-use storage at a six-percent premixed foam solution with fresh water. For ready use do not store below 35 °F and avoid prolonged storage above 120 °F. Only mix with other Type 6 liquid concentrate in accordance with MIL-PRF-24385 and water.

MANUFACTURER'S NAME

CORPORATE ADDRESS

MANUFACTURING ADDRESS

PRODUCT NAME

BATCH NO.

DATE OF MANUFACTURE

FIGURE 2. Type 6 container markings.

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CONCLUDING MATERIAL

Preparing activity:
Navy – SH
(Project 4210-2026-001)

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